

tree on every birthday and try to take care of that tree. You'll love planting trees and Gardening even before you know!

Plants have their own obvious advantages. They take in Carbon-Dioxide, reduce pollution and help in the reduction of Global Warming.

## Buy Local

Even before Independence Gandhi emphasized on this - "make local and buy local". That was of course to kick out the British. But now, that time has come again; we need to buy local stuff and start making more local stuff.

Buying a car from your place instead of getting it shipped, will save a huge amount of fuel that might have been wasted in the transportation. The same applies to grocery shopping too. Try to go to a local grocer to buy groceries instead of buying them from supermarket chains. In these supermarkets, the fruits/vegetables are picked up early after copious spraying of herbicide and pesticide, ripening in a truck on the way here, far from the nutritious and natural benefits of the sun. The local ones will be tasting better as they will be picked up from a local market and hence will have no preservatives. And local production means no emissions from driving, no energy consumption from shipping and storage and hence a very low carbon footprint. See how minor decisions can bring in a huge change!

## Green computing

The ICT industry is currently responsible for 3 per cent of energy consumption in the world. Taking into account the increasing rate of consumption, by 2030, the energy consumption of the world will be doubled because of the ICT industry

Taking into account the amount of PCs, Laptops, Cell phones that are used in day-to-day life and the amount that is being dumped; e-waste in India is a huge problem. Not more than 5 per cent of all the e-waste gets recycled.

Apart from all the e-waste that is produced in the country which is approximately calculated to be 4 lakh tonnes, India is a major importer of e-waste from countries all around the world. Tuticorin port, which is situated 600 kms south of Chennai in Tamil Nadu is heaped with 195 metric tonnes of e-waste imported from Malaysia, Singapore and Saudi Arabia. And this is only the legal calculated e-waste that has been imported with Government regulations. Ports of South India have become an illegal trash-can for all the countries.